

SOURCES/AGENCIES OF SOCIALIZATION

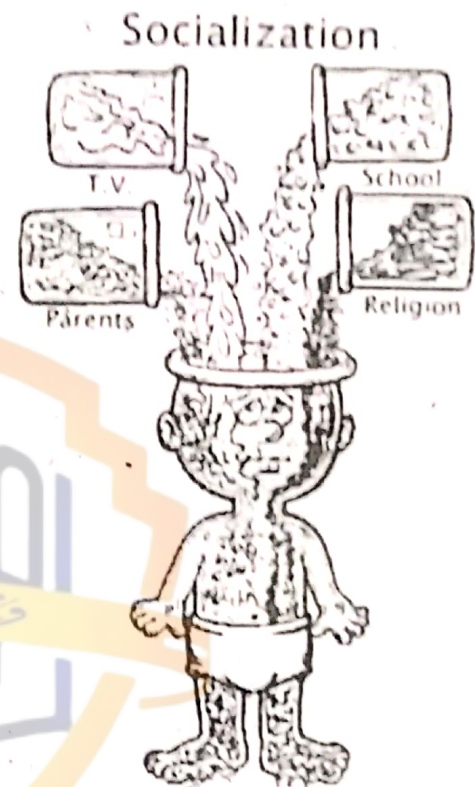
1. The Family

During the socialization process, the family is considered the most significant. There are some factors i.e., Broken home dissatisfaction of basic needs and unbalanced affection of the parents due to which socialization remains incomplete.

2. Peers or Age mates

'Peer groups' means those groups made up of the contemporaries of the child, his associates in school, in playground and in street. He learns from these children, facts and facets of culture that they have previously learnt at different times from their parents. The members of peer groups have other sources of information about the culture - their peers in still other peer groups - and thus the acquisition of culture goes on.

As time passes by of course, the peer group surpasses the parental and family groups in importance. It is true that the 'peer culture' becomes more important and effective than the 'parental culture' in the adolescent years of the child. The advice of one's agemates whether overtly or covertly communicated, sets the standards in almost every aspect of conduct. However, we should not assume that the socialization process is completed by the time the teen ages are reached. On the other hand, this is the time when pressures for conformity are perhaps, at their heights.



3. Social Institutions

The family, markets, mosque, madrasa of religious education, fairs, games and plays, cinema, theatre and national celebrations are the institutions of socialization. A

school is one of the socializing institutions of education. The school, college and university are the formal institutions of education. An individual learns his cultural norms, the values, beliefs, sentiments, habits, customs, rituals and other ways of life through these agencies of socialization. Education is itself a process of socialization. Education teaches the techniques of life to enable an individual to meet his needs of life. This is called socialization. It means socialization is done through these social institutions. Hence, the whole society is itself a learning group.

4. Literature and Mass Media of Communication

This is, of course, found only in literate societies and that is the literature. The civilization that we share is constructed of words or literature. "Words rush at us in torrent and cascade; they leap into our vision, as in billboard and newspaper, magazine and textbook; and assault our ears, as in radio and television". The media of mass communication give us their messages. These messages too contain in capsule form, the premises of our culture, its attitudes and ideologies. The words are always written by someone and these people too - authors and editors and advertisers join the teachers, the peers and the parents in the socialization process. In individual cases, of course, some of these influences are more important than others. The responses can also differ. "Some of us respect tradition; others fear the opinions of their peers, and still others prefer to listen to the 'thousand tongues' of conscience". But all modes of socialization result in conformity of a kind and all thus contribute to the transmission of a culture by some and its acquisition by others.

5. The Community

This is the biggest agency of socialization. A large number of agencies are available in a community which educates its members informally. Man learns ways of life and norms of society by participating in these agencies. He plays his roles in these agencies and gets experiences, which add to his information. This is his socialization in community.

SOCIALIZATION THROUGH THE LIFE COURSE

1. First Stage: Childhood

It starts from at birth age and ends upto 12 years.

Socialization continues throughout the several stages of the life course, most

commonly categorized, as childhood, adolescence, adulthood, and old age. This section sketches some important aspects of the major life course stages.

Despite increasing recognition of the entire life course, childhood (including infancy) certainly remains the most important stage of most people's lives for socialization and for the cognitive, emotional, and physiological development that is so crucial during the early years of anyone's life.

Beyond this basic importance of childhood, however, lies an ugly truth. In regard to education, health, and other outcomes, many children do not fare well during childhood. What happens during childhood can have lifelong consequences. Traumatic experiences during childhood—being neglected or abused, witnessing violence, being seriously injured, and so forth—put youngsters at much greater risk for many negative outcomes. They are more likely to commit serious delinquency during adolescence, and, throughout the life course, they are more likely to experience various psychiatric problems, learning disorders, and substance abuse.

2. Adolescence

According to WHO, An adolescent as any person between age 10-19 years.

Adolescence can be a very challenging time. Teenagers are no longer mere children, but they are not yet full adults. They want their independence, but parents and teachers keep telling them what to do. Peer pressure during adolescence can be enormous, and tobacco, alcohol, and other drug use become a serious problem for many adolescents.

These are all social aspects of adolescence, but adolescence also is a time of great biological change. Emotional (Romantic) relationships, including the desire to be in such a relationship, also matter greatly during adolescence. Wishful thinking, unrequited love, and broken hearts are common issues of this age. Friendship with deviant kinds of person may contribute to delinquency and substance abuse. Adolescence emerged as a buffer between childhood and adulthood. We generally link adolescence, or the teenage years, with emotional and social turmoil as young people struggle to develop their own identities. Again, we are tempted to attribute teenage rebelliousness and confusion to the biological changes of puberty.

3. Adulthood

According to WHO, an adult is a person older than 19 years of age.

Adulthood is the time when most of life's accomplishments take place, including pursuing a career and raising a family. Personalities are largely formed by then, although marked changes in a person's environment—such as unemployment, divorce, or serious illness—may cause significant changes to the self.

(i) Early Adulthood

This age is between 19-40 years of age.

During early adulthood—until about age forty—young adults learn to manage day-to-day affairs for themselves, often juggling conflicting. During this stage of life, many women try to “do it all,” a pattern that reflects the fact that our culture gives them the major responsibility for child rearing and housework even if they have demanding jobs outside the home.



(ii) Middle Adulthood

In middle adulthood—roughly ages forty to sixty five—people sense that their life circumstances are pretty well set. They also become more aware of the fragility of health, which the young typically take for granted. Women who have spent many years raising a family find middle adulthood emotionally trying. Children grow up and require less attention, and husbands become absorbed in their careers, leaving some women with spaces in their lives that are difficult to fill. Many women who divorce also face serious financial problems. For all these reasons, an increasing

number of women in middle adulthood return to school and seek new careers.

For everyone, growing older means experiencing physical decline, a prospect our culture makes especially challenging for women. Because good looks are considered more important for women, the appearance of wrinkles and graying hair can be traumatic. Men have their own particular difficulties as they get older. Some must admit that they are never going to reach earlier career goals. Others realize that the price of career success has been neglect of family or personal health.

4. Old Age

This stage of the life course unofficially begins at the age of 65. Once again, scholars make finer distinctions—such as “young-old” and “old-old”—because of the many differences between people who are 65 or 66 and those who are 85, 86, or even older. Here we will just indicate that old age can be a fulfilling time of life for some people but one filled with anxiety and problems for other people, with social location (social class, race and ethnicity, and gender) once again often making a considerable difference. These problems are compounded by the negative views and even prejudice that many Americans have toward old age and toward people who are old.